

now much-smaller bourse in terms of market share.

Consider this: If the cash market segment is taken into account, BSE's share is in single digits—ranging from 6-9% in most of the recent months. In February, the average daily turnover of BSE was pegged at ₹10,341.08 crore, as against NSE's ₹1,17,032 crore, according to data from the stock exchanges.

The balance was even more skewed in the F&O segment where NSE, which is the world's largest derivatives exchange in terms of the number of contracts traded, had a clear monopoly with BSE's share less than 1% till June last year. However, the efforts of the past few months have ensured that BSE's share has risen from near-zero to nearly 16% in December 2023, and was pegged at 15.30% in February.

Incidentally, if the share price

of the exchange is anything to go by—BSE is the only listed stock exchange in the country—then it seems that the market is also bullish on the prospects of the bourse as the stock has risen more than 65% in the past six months till March 15, as against only 10% gain in the Nifty.

But it is not the immediate gain in market share or even the stock price of the company that Ramamurthy is currently focusing on. His long-term strategy is to turn the bourse around and create a vibrant niche for it in all the segments of the capital market; that plan is still in its initial stages and the BSE boss, who completed a year in office in January 2024, is not in for the short haul.

A VIBRANT EXCHANGE

"There were a lot of challenges when I joined. Some of them continue to exist, while some of them

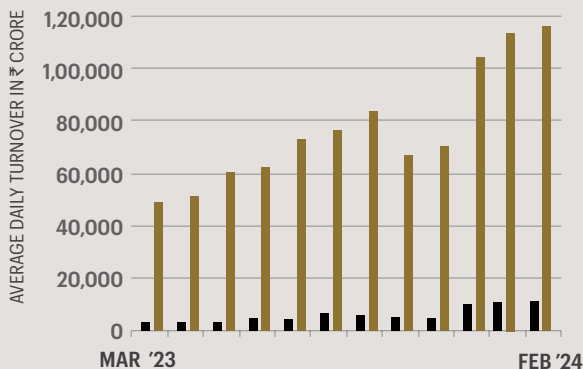
are being addressed meaningfully," says Ramamurthy, sitting in his 25th-floor office at the iconic BSE headquarters, called Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, that offers a bird's eye view of the Arabian Sea and the bustling business district of tony south Mumbai. He says that people often ask him what he means when he says that he wants to make BSE a vibrant exchange. "BSE should have a meaningful presence in all the segments where it has a licence, and it operates [in]. I visualised it in the form of building a block," he explains.

When Ramamurthy took charge in January 2023, he knew that reviving BSE and making it vibrant was not a desk job. He went out on the field and started meeting market participants who are responsible for driving the volumes on the exchanges. "We went in for deeper analysis. We unravelled a lot of interesting things," says

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SMALL BUT STEADY

► In terms of average daily turnover in the cash segment, BSE lags NSE by a huge margin ► But, BSE's share has been rising slowly in the past year

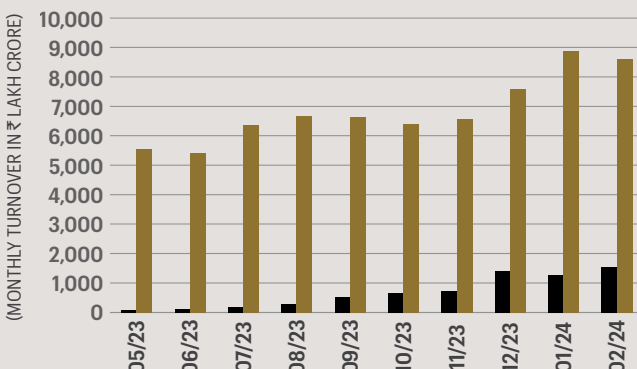


● BSE ● NSE

SOURCE STOCK EXCHANGES

DERIVATIVE GAINS

► Between May 2023 and February 2024, the share of BSE in Equity F&O moved from zero to over 15% ► In February, BSE F&O's total turnover crossed the ₹1,553 lakh crore mark



● BSE ● NSE

SOURCE STOCK EXCHANGES